

profile

Chandaa Narang loves to turn a cliché on its head. "That's the only way it will make sense and flow towards newness," she says. When we catch up with Narang, the CEO of Frazer and Haws (F&H), at her office near Delhi University, she's on one of her rounds, inspecting workers bent over unfinished sculptures. However, instead of a pin-striped suit, she's dressed in a huge pink t-shirt, slacks and sneakers.

Narang is completely at ease. She moves deftly among the scattered tools and blocks of wood—pointing out this, correcting that. She may be very difficult to please, but it's clear that she inspires respect and awe among her workers. "Chandaa is predictably unpredictable," says Archana Singh, president of F&H.

Which explains why she has

brave
ART

ARTIST, SCULPTOR AND CEO
OF FRAZER AND HAWS,
CHANDAA NARANG BELIEVES
THE AGE OF ART IS HERE

never lived life by the rulebook. Back in the early '80s, while studying biochemistry in the US, Narang developed an interest in art and signed up for a liberal arts course at Mills College in California. Soon after, in 1985, she did a course in media and mass communications from Berkeley and took up work as news producer, first in San Francisco and then in London. After three years in media, she opted out to start her own documentary films and photography company. "We made a dozen films or so. But soon, the pressures of the job got to me. People were trying to propose editorial content for my films, which was totally unacceptable," says Narang, who quit in 1997, returned to India and joined F&H.

In those days, F&H had a small budget for India and was totally im-

